SLV

Satellite Launch Vehicle-3 (SLV-3) was India's first experimental satellite launch vehicle, which was an all solid, four stage vehicle weighing 17 tonnes with a height of 22m and capable of placing 40 kg class payloads in Low Earth Orbit (LEO (Low Earth Orbit)).



SLV-3 was successfully launched on July 18, 1980 from Sriharikota Range (SHAR), when Rohini satellite, RS-1, was placed in orbit, thereby making India the sixth member of an exclusive club of space-faring nations . SLV-3 employed an open loop guidance (with stored pitch programme) to steer the vehicle in flight along a pre-determined trajectory. The first experimental flight of SLV-3, in August 1979, was only partially successful. Apart from the July 1980 launch, there were two more launches held in May 1981 and April 1983, orbiting Rohini satellites carrying remote sensing sensors.

The successful culmination of the SLV-3 project showed the way to advanced launch vehicle projects such as the Augmented Satellite Launch Vehicle (ASLV), Polar Satellite Launch Vehicle (PSLV) and the Geosynchronous satellite Launch Vehicle (GSLV).

More Details
Launchers
Sounding Rockets

SLV

- List of SLV Launches

ASLV

PSLV

GSLV

GSLV Mk III

SSLV

RLV-TD

Scramjet Engine - TD

Address

ISRO Headquarters, Antariksh Bhavan, New BEL Road
Bengaluru-560 094

Phone: +91 80 22172294 / 96
Email: isropr[at]isro[dot]gov[dot]in

Last updated on : Mon Sep 28 2026 17:35:27 GMT+0530 (India Standard Time)

© Copyright **2023 ISRO**. All Rights Reserved